

## **Notrump Bidding**

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced\* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced\* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

\*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead:  6

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead:  2

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: South

Lead:  4

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: West

Lead:  10

**Board 1**

West Deals

None Vul

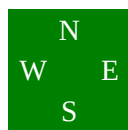
♠ A 9 7 5 4  
 ♥ 8 7 6  
 ♦ 10  
 ♣ A 8 4 2

♠ K Q J

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 8

♣ Q J 10



♠ 2

♥ A 10 3

♦ Q 9 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 10 8 6 3

♥ K 4 2

♦ K 4 3

♣ K 7 5

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener.

SOUTH has 9 points: - if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game. - if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game. Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she accepts the invitation.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| Pass         | 1NT          | Pass        | 2NT          |
| Pass         | 3NT          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by North |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♦ 6    |              |             |              |

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 8 4  
♥ K 7 2  
♦ Q 6 5  
♣ K J 9 3

♠ Q 3

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ 8 7 3 2

♣ 7 5 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 9 7 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8

♠ K J 5 2

♥ 8 6 3

♦ K 10 9

♣ A 6 4

With 9 points WEST is unable to decide the final contract. If EAST has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If EAST opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So WEST makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells EAST that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal EAST has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              | 1NT         | Pass         |
| 2NT         | Pass         | 3NT         |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 3NT by East |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♠ 2   |              |             |              |

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9 7  
♥ Q 6 5 4 2  
♦ 9 7 5  
♣ Q 3

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ 10 8 4

♣ 8 7 4



♠ 8 5 3

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ A J 6 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5

This time SOUTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

NORTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

SOUTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              | Pass        | 1NT          |
| Pass         | 2NT          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 2NT by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥4     |              |             |              |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 6  
♥ A J 10 3  
♦ A Q  
♣ K J 5 2

♠ A 9 8  
♥ Q  
♦ K 10 9 8 6  
♣ A Q 10 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 7 4 2  
♥ 8 5  
♦ J 4 2  
♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ 10 5 3  
♥ K 9 7 6 4 2  
♦ 7 5 3  
♣ 6

WEST has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

EAST adds her 2 points to WEST's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2NT         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 2NT by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ 10  |       |      |       |